

surveillance is shrouded by secrecy and centralised by authorities, surveillance is distributed and open. Currently, our smartphones happen to be surveillance monitors, but in the coming generation wearables like eye glasses will play an integral part in removing data corruption from centralised surveillance systems.

- ◆ **Smart Watches:** Smart watches need no introduction. The existing trend with smartwatches is the attempt to bring your smartphone to your wrist through them, but that's definitely not their final stage. Smartwatches may eventually be an all-in-one device for activity monitoring, data processing and obviously communication.
- ◆ **Head-Mounted Displays (HMDs):** When HMDs are discussed, the first thing that comes to mind is the Google Glass, which is an augmented reality (AR) device. The Oculus Rift, on the other hand, is an example of a virtual reality (VR) head-mounted display.

To understand the difference between AR and VR, let's first define "reality". Reality is the conjectured state of things as they actually exist, rather than as they may appear or imagined to be. HMDs modify our reality via two routes: Augmented reality and Virtual reality.

- ◆ "Augmented Reality" (AR) is a live, direct or indirect view of a physical, real-world environment whose elements are augmented (or supplemented) by computer-generated sensory input such as sound, video, graphics or GPS data. It's related to a more general concept called "mediated reality", in which a view of reality is modified (possibly even diminished rather than augmented) by a computer.
- ◆ "Virtual Reality" (VR), often referred to as "immersive multimedia" or "computer-simulated life", virtually replicates a real world or imagined environment and simulates the user's physical presence in those places, thus allowing you to interact with objects and people in that world. Virtual reality artificially creates sensory experiences, which can include sight, hearing, touch, smell, taste and more.

The future of wearables isn't just limited to the above described categories. It's much more broader. For example, let's consider the exoskeletons, which have on many occasions helped the physically handicapped in day-to-day activities.

But medical applications aside, exoskeletons are now shifting to other sectors, like military. The 'Human Universal Load Carrier' or 'HULC' is an un-tethered, hydraulic-powered anthropomorphic exoskeleton developed by Professor H. Kazerooni and his team at Ekso Bionics. It is intended to